The Riding Collective

No longer merely a set of wheels to get from one point to another, motorcycles have become a way of life—fuelled by a younger, more financially empowered consumer as well as a burgeoning riding community culture.

BY RAHUL GHOSH



For decades, motorcycles in India have been synonymous with commuting. From the daily office run to the last-mile delivery of food and parcels, two-wheelers have been the backbone of everyday mobility. Yet, beyond our shores, motorcycles have long represented something far more aspirational—a passion, a pursuit of freedom, and a way of life.

Adventure tourers are built to cover thousands of kilometres, crossing countries and exploring untrodden paths. With powerful engines, highway comfort, off-road capability and panniers packed with essentials or camping gear, these machines celebrate the journey as much as the destination.

Supersports are precision-engineered machines built for mountain bends and race tracks, thrilling riders with razor-sharp handling, breathtaking speed and the exhilaration of leaning into corners with knees skimming the tarmac.

India's motorcycling lifestyle began taking shape in the 1980s, when foreign travellers, particularly Europeans, explored the Himalayas on hired motorcycles, especially the Royal Enfield Bullet. Recognising the emerging trend, Royal Enfield nurtured one of India's earliest organised riding communities through curated expeditions, factory support and service assistance. Royal Enfield made motorcycling synonymous with adventure, exploration and camaraderie.

On September 20, 2026, Royal Enfield's One Ride united over 1,50,000 riders across 60 countries through 1,600-plus journeys, making it the initiative's largest edition since 2011. Celebrating its 125th year, the brand brought riders together to champion snow leopard conservation and protect the high Himalayas, a place they call home.

International brands accelerated motorcycling's lifestyle appeal in India. As import barriers eased,